



COLUMBUS, DIVISION OF FIRE SYSTEMS MANUAL 2026 Edition v1.0

REVISIONS

CHAPTER I

Added Medical Operations and EMS Bureau

CHAPTER II

Section 202

202.13 The use of electronic communications does not circumvent the need to properly notify the Chain-of-Command. Communications submitted by email through the chain of command shall be sent to the next level only. Members shall not cc/bcc all levels of the chain of command when submitting electronic communications. **(Moved to Section 336: Communications)**

202.13.1 Officers shall promptly approve, acknowledge, and/or comment on communications received by email before submitting to the next level of the chain of command. No officer or Division member shall suppress, disregard, or unduly delay any such communication. **(Moved to Section 336: Communications)**

Section 204: General Rules and Conduct

- Reorganized to reflect the order of the Central Work Rules

204.72 Members are expressly prohibited from using Division vehicles or apparatus for the purpose of running personal errands or attending to other business that is not Division-related. Specific examples of such unauthorized use would include, but not be limited to, using fire apparatus or vehicles for shopping, banking, etc. Members required to use their Division vehicles while on stand-by status shall use good judgment in order to prevent criticism of the Division. **(Moved to Section 206: Performance of Duties)**

Section 206:

206.24 Members shall, when exposed to a contagious disease while on duty, report this fact to their immediate superior as soon as possible and complete all required forms and reports as detailed elsewhere in this manual. **(Moved to Section 364: Health and Safety)**

Section 230: SUBPOENA PROCEDURES **(Moved to Section 750: Subpoena/Summons)**

- Combined subpoena/summons to one location

- 230.00 Members will not be compensated, or relieved of duty with pay, for subpoenas which are not a result of their duties and/or position with the Division of Fire, or for instances in which the member is either a plaintiff or complainant in a civil action or administrative proceeding, or a defendant in a criminal action.
- 230.10 Division members are expected to honor any subpoena they receive, but they will be eligible for overtime compensation only if they follow the appropriate procedures as listed in current Division S.O.P.'s.

CHAPTER III

300: Training

- Revisions to 300.06

300.06 Members of the Division who have attained Journeyman Firefighter Status may apply for temporary recruit instructor positions by ~~completing the Division of Fire Instructor's Profile (Form TA-514) and filling out an Application for Temporary Instructors. These forms can be obtained from member's Battalion Chiefs, and must be submitted through normal Division channels to the Chief of Training.~~ **submitting an RT-154 to the Training Bureau Assistant Chief.**

312: Assignments (addition)

314: Temporary Transfers (revised)

- Reorganized and added definitions/procedures for short- and long-term transfers

316 Grooming

- Section with earrings 316.36 (general standards) deleted. Policy with earrings referenced under 338 only
- 316.36 Members working in administrative positions (except fire recruits) may wear a single pair of plain earrings of the post or button type in pierced ears. All other personnel shall not be permitted to wear earrings of any type due to safety regulations for emergency services and fire operations. **(Deleted)**

324: Added Display of National Colors from Section 416

330: Awards and Meritorious Conduct

- Combined all awards information into one section
- Awards Screening Committee: significant changes with additional committee members added
- Revised language to represent change in committee members

358: Combined 358.04 with 358.02

- 358.02 No Division member will participate in advertising of any product or service, while identifying themselves; as, or in any manner representing themselves as, a Division member.
- 358.04 No Division member will publicly endorse any products or services while identifying themselves as, or in any manner representing themselves as, a Division member.

CHAPTER IV

416: Moved Display of National Colors 416 to Section 324

404.12 deleted

- 404.12 Company Commanders, before approving requests for the trading of time, shall make certain that the provisions of the Division's Trading of Time Policy are strictly followed. (Deleted)

404.14 & 404.18 combined with 404.16; renumbered to 404.12

404.14 Company Commanders shall see that all members of their company wear the regulation breathing apparatus furnished by the Division for their protection.

404.16 Company Commanders shall be responsible for assuring that all personnel under their supervision have, and when necessary wear, all required articles of protective clothing. These include such items as protective hoods, helmets, eye protection, turnout coats and pants, boots, gloves and other protective gear as needed.

404.18 Company Commanders shall be responsible for ensuring that full protection goggles, safety glasses or protective face shields are worn by members when needed.

404.32: changed to reference station captain not battalion chief

404.32 Company Commanders shall notify their ~~Battalion Chief~~ **station captain** and be guided by the ~~Battalion Chief's~~ **station captain's** instructions before they allow any item to be added to or deleted from the normal complement of equipment carried on the apparatus.

406.38: revised

406.38 When going off duty, members excused from standing roll call for authorized reasons more than three times in succession shall have their names submitted to the Division Administration Officer. This shall apply whether the absences were covered by obtaining trades with oncoming members or other circumstances prevailed. Names of such members, together with an explanation of the particulars involved, shall be submitted by their immediate supervisors. Properly relieved personnel, such as Battalion Chiefs and Fire Alarm Dispatchers shall not be included under the provisions of this paragraph.

Revision:

406.38 When going off duty, a supervisor may excuse a member from standing roll call for authorized reasons, obtaining trades with oncoming members or other circumstances. An officer may disapprove especially with excessive requests to be excused from roll call.

408.10: revised

408.10 Each day at the completion of the daily schedule, Company Commanders shall hold a critique with the members of their companies. This critique should consist of an informal review and evaluation of the day's activities, and will have the following goals:

- a. Follow-up on job assignments.
- b. Relay information gained by individual company members.
- c. Relay and review PA messages, bulletins, verbal orders, and any other pertinent information that may have been received during periods when one or more company members were not present.

Revision:

408.10 Each day at the completion of the daily schedule, Company Commanders shall relay and review PA messages, bulletins, verbal orders, and any other pertinent information that may have been received during periods when one or more company members were not present.

408.18: deleted

408.18 Each day at the completion of the weekend or holiday routine work schedule, Company Commanders shall hold a critique with the members of their companies. This critique should consist of an informal review and evaluation of the day's activities, having the same goals as those stated in Section 408.10.

410.10: deleted

410.10 If it becomes necessary for the station watchman to be away from or out of direct sight of the immediate vicinity of the watch area for more than just a moment or two, he or she shall first secure the permission of the officer in charge, and should also attempt to get the alternate watchman or some other station member to provide coverage for the duration of this absence.

420.10 moved to Section 418: Snow Removal; 418.10

420.10 Company Commanders and other Division members shall be responsible for ensuring that snow or ice is not allowed to accumulate between the overhead door weather stripping and the floor. A buildup of snow or ice under the door may result in damage to the door motor or drive belt, due to the door not being able to close completely, and

may even prevent the door from opening in cases where the door freezes to the concrete floor.

Section 426 Station Laundry Procedures: ~~deleted~~

CHAPTER VI

602.16 - 602.22: deleted

HOSE MARKING DATA

602.16 The size and placement of identifying company numbers used on hose shall be uniform throughout the Division.

602.18 Each section of hose shall be marked so that the base of company number is parallel to the horizontal plane of the section of hose, on both sides of the hose jacket.

602.20 Company markings shall be applied so that the finished number is approximately fifteen inches (15") from the male coupling, with the coupling being to the right of the number. For hose sections having no designated male or female coupling, the number shall be placed approximately fifteen inches from one end or the other (on both sides of the hose jacket) with the nearest coupling being to the right of the number.

602.22 The size of the numbers used on the various sizes of hose shall be the height of the hose when hose is laid flat and shall be 1/4 inch in width.

604.36: revised

604.36 Regularly scheduled oil changes, filter replacements, and general chassis lubrication of all Division vehicles shall be performed according to the following schedule:

Diesel Powered Apparatus:

Oil and Filter Change 100 hours

Fuel Filter Change as needed

Lubrication monthly

NOTE: For those diesel engines not equipped with engine-hour meters, the odometer reading shall be used, converting each 4000 engine miles to 100 engine hours.

Gasoline Powered Apparatus:

Oil and Filter Change 4,000 road miles

Lubrication According to manufacturer's recommendation -usually with the oil change

Revision:

604.36 Regularly scheduled oil changes, filter replacements, and general chassis lubrication of all Division vehicles shall be performed according to Fleet Management.

604.44: deleted

604.44 On-duty company commanders and bureau heads shall ensure that, on the 20th day of each month, the information necessary to accurately compile the monthly mileage report is obtained for each vehicle permanently assigned to their station, including supplementary apparatus.

608.06: revised to include ET-68

608.06 After completing the daily equipment check, appropriate entries shall be made in the company journal with regard to the status of the equipment. Missing or damaged tools or equipment shall be listed, and any other pertinent information concerning such equipment shall be recorded and, if necessary, appropriate reports submitted. The failure or damage of tools, equipment, or hose requires that a letter of explanation be initiated by the Company Commander and sent through the proper channels to the Chief. ~~the item being tagged OOS and ET-68 completed.~~

608.22 moved to 610.08

608.22 All gasoline powered tools and equipment shall be started and run outdoors weekly until the individual piece of equipment reaches its operating temperature. This should normally be accomplished within ten to twenty minutes. Equipment such as generators, saws, exhaust fans, electrical cords, etc., shall be maintained according to the specific requirements of each piece of equipment. (610.08)

614.12: replaced FAO with battalion chief

614.12 When the amount of hose to be changed exceeds one half (1/2) of the normal complement of a particular size hose (excluding 2" or smaller), ~~the Fire Alarm Office~~ (battalion chief) must be contacted and permission obtained to call the apparatus out of service in order to make the change. If changing less than one half (1/2) of the hose load, companies need not call out of service.

614.24: deleted

614.24 The folds of all hose loaded on Division apparatus shall be changed at least monthly to reduce damage from kinks, mildew, and other harmful actions. The folds of synthetic rubber ribbed hose shall be changed three (3) times per year, in January, May, and

September, once by each unit. During the change the hose shall be inspected for damage and the couplings lubricated.

614.26: deleted

614.26 All hose stored in fire stations shall be removed from its place of storage, unrolled, inverted, and re-rolled at least quarterly.

614.28: added

614.28 Hose shall be maintained using the manufacture's recommended maintenance which at minimum includes: inspection for cuts and other damage, including bulges and abrasions in the hose wall that might indicate a weak spot. Checking the couplings for damaged threads, broken pins or lugs, out-of-round couplings, and condition of the gaskets.

614.32: deleted

614.32 All hose stored in the various fire stations shall, whenever possible, be stored so as to permit the free circulation of air and shall be inspected at least monthly for signs of mildew and other indications of deterioration.

614.46-.96: deleted; previously moved to SOP

622.06-08: deleted

622.06 In order to be certain that this equipment is adequately maintained and will operate properly when needed, all radiation instruments assigned to the Division shall be check and tested by the personnel assigned to the stations or bureaus where such instruments are located.

622.08 Radiation instruments that are defective or in need of repair shall be sent to Office Research and Development. When sending in these instruments, be sure to include the entire kit and attach a repair tag stating the date, station number, unit, officers name, and instruments that are defective. The Office of Research and Development will then forward the kits to the Emergency Management Agency for exchange.

640.12: deleted

640.12 A map (Station and Battalion Water Atlas) showing the locations of all hydrants within assigned districts shall be prepared and maintained by each Company Commander, who shall also ensure that such map is kept updated, both for company schooling purposes and for the possible use by the Battalion Chief.

640.24: deleted

640.24 Company Commanders are responsible for seeing that the pages of each Water Atlas assigned to their station are maintained accurately and kept up to date. This includes any Water Atlas assigned to any vehicle or apparatus quartered therein.

640.34: deleted

640.34 Each Monday, the Division Hydrant Coordinator shall prepare and distribute a "Hydrant Out of Service" report from Hydrant Web to the Emergency Services Deputy Chiefs, all Battalion Chiefs, the Water Maintenance Engineer and the Water Distribution Manager. This report will show all known public hydrants within the City of Columbus that are currently out of service.

640.96: deleted

640.96 A master hydrant map will be maintained in each Fire Station; if any boundary of an assigned company district is not understood, the Company Commander responsible for such district shall contact the Division Hydrant Coordinator for clarification.

CHAPTER VII

702.02: 40hr vacation added

702.02 Personnel assigned to a 40-hour position, whether temporary or permanent, will be guided by the appropriate bureau head for vacation procedures.

710 (attendance) revision

- Re-titled section to Attendance
- Defined attendance categories
- Re-numbered
- Revised Penalties to 24-month period from 12-month period
- For purposes of disciplinary review specific to the 24-month period, violations occurring prior to June 1, 2025, shall not be considered or included in the review.

710.12: revised

710.12 Company Commanders and/or other immediate supervisor shall make the appropriate entries concerning members reporting late for duty on the daily Personnel Status Report (Telestaff) and the daily log. ~~and in the company journal (Form PL-7). All entries in the company journal less than one (1) year old shall be preserved.~~

713: Light Duty (New Section)

- Light Duty separated for individual section; added content for medical documentation for HR only
 - All medical documentation shall be submitted directly to the Division's Human Resources Office.

714: Return to Duty

- added content for medical documentation for HR only, employee affirms to supervisor "no restrictions"
 1. Affirm to supervisor the ability to work without restrictions
 2. Present a written statement from their personal physician to Human Resources indicating no restrictions due to recent illness.

718: Addition:

- removal of Lactation SOP; allows individualized plan with reasonable accommodations

742: Unpaid Absence

- combined with 710

750: Subpoenas/Summons

- revised order but not content
- Added content from Section 230; under one location

CHAPTER VIII

No content revisions;

- Moved sections 818,820, & 822 to 816
- Moved section 830 to 828
- Moved section 832 to 828
- Moved section 836 to 834